Mississippi Burning | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Write brief answers. Use scenes for analysis. No graphic descriptions or slurs are needed.

Before viewing

1. Why might a witness hesitate to speak when powerful people support violence?

During viewing

2. What event brings Anderson and Ward to Mississippi?

3. How do the two agents’ initial approaches differ?

4. How do local officials respond to the federal investigation?

5. Why are many Black residents cautious about speaking to the agents?

6. How do attacks on homes and churches function as intimidation?

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During viewing

7. What does Mrs. Pell reveal about the cost of challenging the local code of silence?

8. How does the discovery of the victims change the investigation?

9. What connection does the film show between racist groups and local power?

10. How do Anderson’s later tactics raise questions about justice and methods?

After viewing

11. What does the investigation’s outcome resolve, and what remains unresolved?

12. How does centering the FBI agents affect whose actions viewers notice?

13. Choose a film claim to check. How would two different sources help?

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